

Install Android on Iphone

Six easy steps to install Android on the iPhone
<http://lifehack.kr/eMNjrC>

Latest Wikileaks release

Nearly 800 secret documents from the Guantanamo
 Prison in Cuba have been released by Wikileaks

Sony Ericsson Xperia Arc

Redefining sleekness but what else?

To call the Xperia Arc sleek and slim would be an understatement. One look and exclamations burst forth - its classic profile, impossibly slim tapering waistline and the winning combination of curves and angles that make devices like the HTC Desire HD and the original Xperia X10i look like fossils. But it is the front that captivates - a wonderful blend of large glass expanse that includes the display and bezel, and three distinct chromed buttons sitting beneath it, on the cusp of a downward slope. Kudos to Sony Ericsson for producing what has to be one of the sexiest looking phones ever, and the Arc looks better in silver than in black, the battery cover that we find shockingly cheap in contrast to the superlative design.

Specifications

Display: 4.2-inches, 480 x 854 pixels; OS: Android 2.3; SoC: Qualcomm MSM 8255; RAM: 512 MB; memory expansion: microSD; battery: 1500 mAh; Weight: 116 grams

Contact

Sony Ericsson India

Phone: 1800-111-800

Web site: www.sonyericsson.com

Price: ₹32,000 (MRP)

Light she is, at 116 grams, but an airhead she is not, for the Arc houses a Qualcomm MSM 8255 with 512 MB of RAM, enough to keep Gingerbread running smoothly, with the odd recalcitrant hiccup. And no, unlike the Galaxy S, the rear doesn't get warm after prolonged use. The three designer buttons we spoke of are soft, and exude good feedback, it would be nice to have the functions of these keys backlit though. The power button located on the top is delineated and easy to use, as is (surprisingly) the small but intuitive volume rocker. The 3.5mm jack is located to the left side, while the charging port is located on the right, with a useful LED indicator. The camera button works quite well, with an intuitive half click autofocus. There is a micro HDMI port housed beneath a flap - useful for streaming content to your HDTV, although the Arc lacks the necessary connector.

The 4.2-inch display offers good colour and contrast, with the Bravia Engine making a difference, although what's with missing out on DivX/Xvid playback? Text is super sharp - tiny font sizes are also very readable. The capacitive touch is sensitive, the onscreen keypad on the Arc works well and is quite intuitive.

There are five home screens and a bar that can contain up to four shortcuts, although removing a shortcut like the media folder from this bar prompts for a delete of all stored media, while others like Messaging can be removed,

and replaced from the main menu - strange.

While browsing using EDGE we had a couple of hiccups when our server connection was inexplicably lost, while two other phones had no problems on the same network. The Arc came with no Office suite installed and the interface lags, even when scrolling through locally stored SMS'.

Signal quality is good, although call clarity isn't as good, the earpiece volume nosedives 50 per cent of what it is on other calls. Additionally, cutting a call doesn't work immediately and one has to touch the control again, after a second - annoying. The hands-free is pretty good. The

loudspeaker isn't loud in addition to being directional and tinny, and distorts at maximum volume, though not at 2 rungs lower. The hands-free offers good music quality with decent bass and an enjoyable mid-range. Panning and zooming while browsing could be a

bit faster. In general, the Arc isn't as speedy through its menus as the HTC Desire HD, that runs the same SoC.

The camera offers good crispness and colour outdoors - very acceptable for a cell-phone camera. Indoor photo quality takes a beating and the flash isn't as powerful as the unit on the Desire HD. Battery life is decent for a touch-screen phone, though certainly not spectacular - the Arc will see through a moderate day of mailing and surfing on a single charge with an hour of music.

At an MRP of ₹32,000, the Arc sure has flagship pricing, and is expensive given the competition is priced lower. Also, unlike the Desire HD, who's interface and applications ran perfectly, the Arc comes across as having been rushed to a release date to control the competition, and

Sony Ericsson should have ironed out the little niggles we faced. Additionally with the competition announcing dual-core phones and given Sony Ericssons slowness to market of Android phones, we're wondering if the Arc is 6 months late. The Arc is gorgeous in the flesh, but beneath it lie imperfections that make us hesitate.

Michael Browne



7.0
10

Features.....7.5
 Performance.....6.5
 Build.....7.0
 Value for money.....6.0